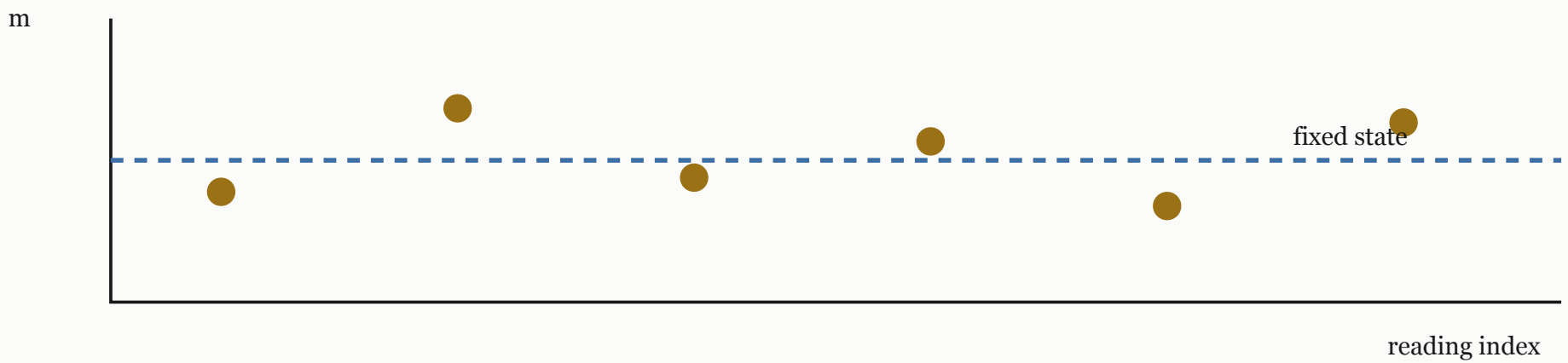
# From Noisy Readings to Reliable Estimates

Which position should a noisy sensor report?




> One stationary object. Several different readings.

`state` · `measurements` · `inferred answer`

Report an estimate and the uncertainty around it.

Probability model; parameter estimation — [1] DL §3.1 · [1] DL §5.5.1 · Course example

WHY

# Uncertainty

What does a distribution add to a model?

$$z = x + \varepsilon$$

- $x$ unknown state (m)
- $z$ observed reading (m)
- $\varepsilon$ random error (m)

Tools: random variables · PMF / PDF · moments · Gaussian geometry

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Data + model | ⟶ | Likelihood | ⟶ | MLE |
| Prior + likelihood | ⟶ | Bayes → posterior | ⟶ | MAP / credible interval |
| Repeated data + model | ⟶ | Sampling distribution | ⟶ | Confidence interval |

> Uncertainty describes the model, not a moving wall.

Probability distribution; uncertainty — [1] DL §3.1 · Course concept map

# Random variables

How does an outcome become a number?

$$x : \Omega \to \mathbb{R}, \qquad x(\omega) \in \{-1, 0, 2\}$$

- $\Omega$ possible outcomes
- $\omega$ one outcome
- $x$ random variable: numerical error (cm)

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Outcome A → −1 cm | Outcome B → 0 cm | Outcome C → 2 cm |

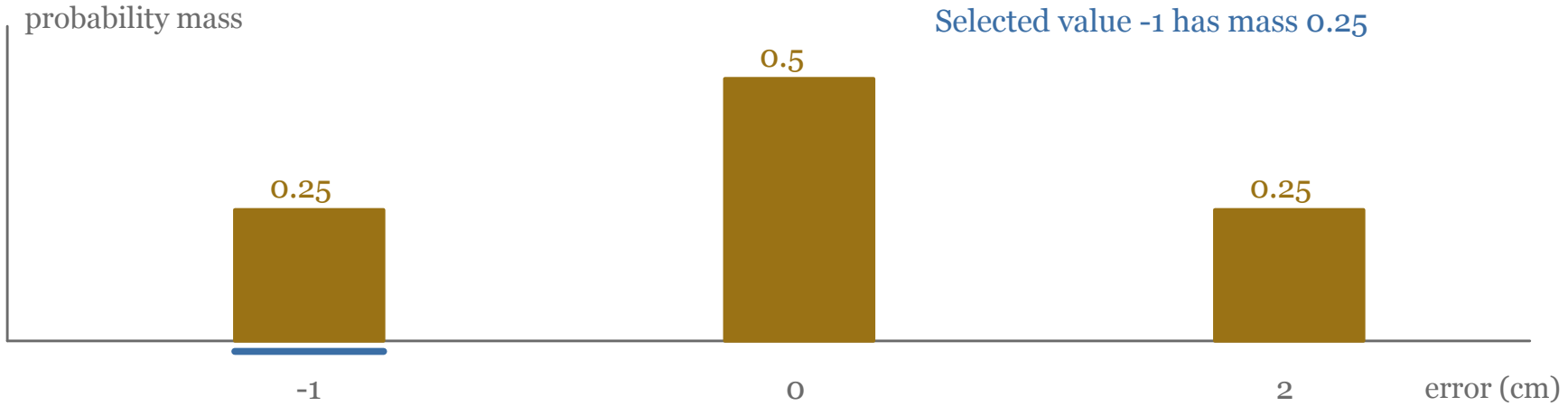
> The rule is fixed; the outcome is uncertain.

Random variable; realization — [1] DL §3.2

DEFINITION AND REASONING

# PMF and PDF

How do probabilities attach to discrete values?




$$p(a) = P(x = a), \qquad p(a) \geq 0, \qquad \sum_{a} p(a) = 1$$

$x$ discrete random error — $a$ possible value (cm)

$p(a)$ probability mass — $P$ event probability

Probability mass function (PMF) — [1] DL §3.3.1

# PMF and PDF

## What does the three-point error model predict?

Error values −1, 0, 2 cm; masses ¼, ½, ¼. Find nonnegative-error probability and mean.

$$P(x \geq 0) = \tfrac{1}{2} + \tfrac{1}{4} = \tfrac{3}{4}, \qquad \mu = (-1)\tfrac{1}{4} + 0\tfrac{1}{2} + 2\tfrac{1}{4} = \tfrac{1}{4}$$

- $P$ event probability
- $x$ error (cm)
- $\mu$ mean error (cm)

Discrete probability; expectation — [1] DL §3.3.1 · [1] DL §3.8 · Course example

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# PMF and PDF

## Which values belong to the event?

Errors $-1, 0, 2$ cm have masses $1/2, 1/4, 1/4$. What is $P(x \geq 0)$?

- **A** $1/4$: count only positive errors.
- **B** $1/2$: include zero and positive errors.
- **C** $2/3$: two of three possible values.

Event probability; PMF — [1] DL §3.3.1 · Course question

DEFINITION AND REASONING

# PMF and PDF

Why does a continuous event need an area?

$$P(a \le x \le b) = \int_a^b p(t)\,dt$$

- $x$ random quantity with density $p$
- $a, b$ interval endpoints
- $t$ integration variable
- $p(t)$ probability density function (PDF), inverse units of x

$$P(x = c) = \int_c^c p(t)\,dt = 0$$

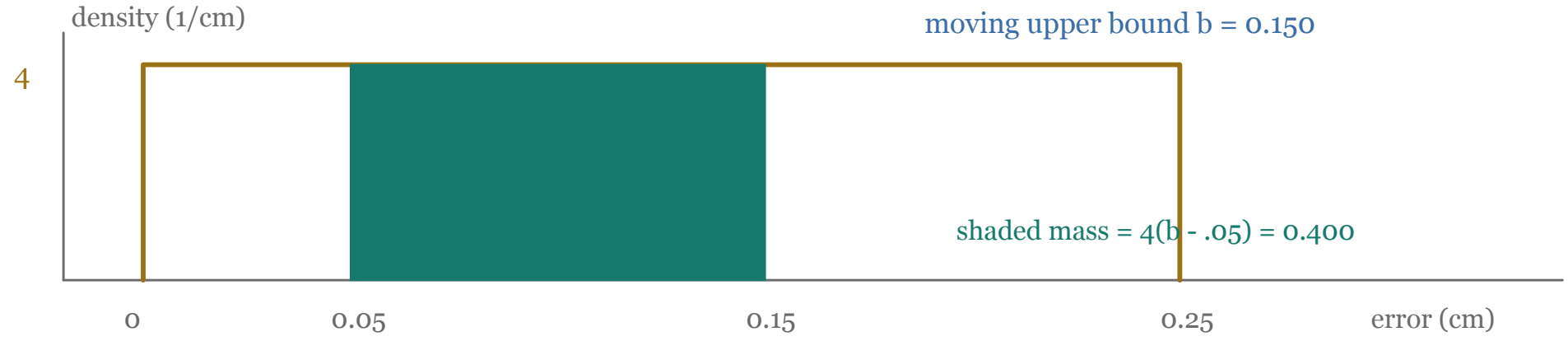
- $c$ one fixed value
- $P$ probability for a variable with a density

Probability density function (PDF) — [1] DL §3.3.2

DEFINITION AND REASONING

# PMF and PDF

## Can a valid density be greater than one?




**UNIFORM ERROR**

$$p(t) = 4 \;\; (0 \le t \le .25), \qquad P(.05 \le x \le .15) = 4(.15 - .05) = .4$$

| | |
|---|---|
| $t, x$ | error (cm) |
| $p$ | density ($\text{cm}^{-1}$) |
| $P$ | interval probability |

Uniform density; normalization — [1] DL §3.3.2 · Course example

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# PMF and PDF

## Density is height; probability is area

$x$ is uniform on $[0, .5]$ cm. Which statement is valid?

A. Density 2 $\text{cm}^{-1}$; $P(.1 \leq x \leq .3) = .4$.

B. Density 2 means event probability 2.

C. Probability is .2, the interval width alone.

Density; event probability — [1] DL §3.3.2 · Course question

# Moments

How do we average a function of a random value?

$$\mathbb{E}[g(x)] = \sum_{a} g(a)p(a)$$

- $x$ discrete random variable
- $a$ support value
- $g$ function being averaged
- $p$ PMF

$$\mathbb{E}[g(x)] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} g(t)p(t)\,dt$$

- $x$ continuous random variable
- $t$ integration variable
- $p$ density
- $g$ assume E[|g(x)|] is finite

Expectation of a function — [1] DL §3.8 · Course derivation

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Moments

## What does centering remove?

$\mathrm{Var}(x) = \mathbb{E}[(x-\mu)^2]$. Given $\mu = 1/4$ cm and $\mathbb{E}[x^2] = 5/4$ cm$^2$, choose the variance.

A $5/4$: the second moment is always variance.

B $1$: subtract the mean, not its square.

C $19/16$: subtract the squared mean.

Centering; variance — [1] DL §3.8 · Course question

DEFINITION AND REASONING

# Moments

What is the mean of a random column vector?

$$x = \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \mu = \mathbb{E}[x] = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbb{E}[x_1] \\ \mathbb{E}[x_2] \end{bmatrix}$$

- $x$ random column in $\mathbb{R}^2$
- $x_i$ component i
- $\mu$ mean column in $\mathbb{R}^2$

> Average corresponding components; preserve the column shape.

Samples use superscripts: $x^{(s)}$. Components use subscripts: $x_i$.

Random vector; mean vector — [1] DL §3.8

# Moments

Why does covariance use an outer product?

$$\Sigma = \mathbb{E}[(x-\mu)(x-\mu)^T], \qquad \Sigma_{ij} = \mathbb{E}[(x_i-\mu_i)(x_j-\mu_j)]$$

- $x, \mu$ — random column and mean in $\mathrm{R}^d$
- $\Sigma$ — population covariance, d × d
- $i, j$ — coordinate indices

> Diagonal: component variance. Off-diagonal: paired deviations.

Covariance matrix — [1] DL §3.8 · Course derivation

# Moments

## Why is covariance positive semidefinite?

$$a^T \Sigma a = \mathbb{E}[(a^T(x-\mu))^2] \geq 0$$

- $a$ fixed direction column in $\mathrm{R}^d$
- $x, \mu$ random column and population mean
- $\Sigma$ population covariance: PSD means $a^T \Sigma a \geq 0$ for every $a$

$$C = \frac{X_c^T X_c}{N-1} \quad (N > 1)$$

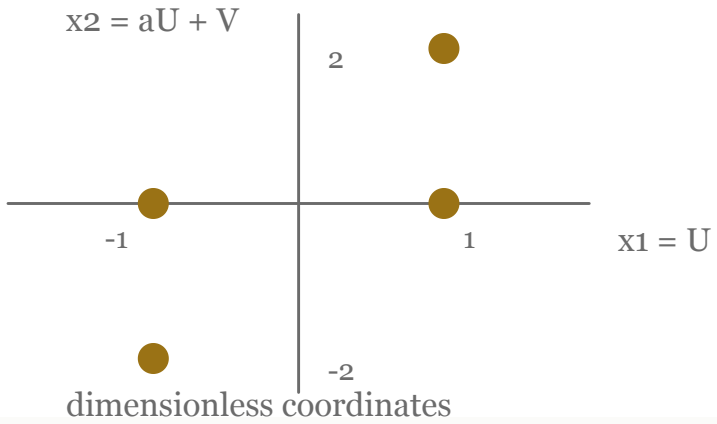
- $C$ sample covariance estimate
- $X_c$ N centered sample rows
- $N$ number of samples

Positive semidefinite covariance — [1] DL §3.8 · Course derivation

DEFINITION AND REASONING

# Moments

## How do independent signs create correlation?




dimensionless coordinates

a = 1.00

four equally likely outcomes

a: 0 to 1 adds the shared sign

Independent fair signs U,V: knowing one does not change the other's probabilities. Let $x = (U, U+V)^T$.

$$\mu = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

$U, V$ independent, equally likely ±1 — $x, \mu$ random column and mean — $\Sigma$ population covariance

Independence; covariance — [1] DL §3.7 · [1] DL §3.8 · Course example

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Moments

## Independent sources, dependent components

$U, V$ are independent fair signs. Let $x = (U, 2U + V)^T$. What is $\mathrm{Cov}(x_1, x_2)$?

A 2: both components share $U$.

B 0: independent sources imply independent outputs.

C 1: doubling a coefficient has no effect.

Independence; covariance — [1] DL §3.7 · [1] DL §3.8 · Course question

DEFINITION AND REASONING

# Moments

## Does zero covariance guarantee independence?

x is uniform on {−1,0,1}; y=x². Is y independent of x?

$$\mathrm{Cov}(x, y) = 0, \qquad P(y = 0 \mid x = 0) = 1 \neq \tfrac{1}{3} = P(y = 0)$$

| | |
|---|---|
| $x, y$ | random scalars |
| $P$ | event probability |
| Cov | population covariance |

Uncorrelatedness; independence — [1] DL §3.8 · [2] UBC Lec.18 p.8 · Course example

DEFINITION AND REASONING

# Gaussian geometry

What defines a multivariate Gaussian density?

$$p(x) = (2\pi)^{-d/2} |\Sigma|^{-1/2} \exp(-d_M^2/2)$$

- $x, \mu$ random column and mean in $\mathrm{R}^d$
- $d$ dimension
- $\Sigma \succ 0$ positive variance in every nonzero direction
- $|\Sigma|$ determinant
- $p$ density
- $d_M^2$ squared Mahalanobis distance

$$d_M^2 = (x-\mu)^T \Sigma^{-1} (x-\mu)$$

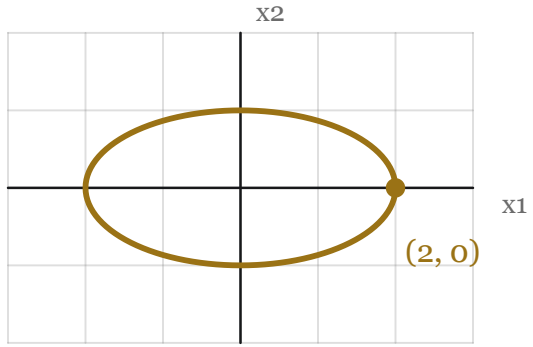
- $\Sigma^{-1}$ inverse covariance
- $x - \mu$ centered displacement

Multivariate Gaussian distribution — [1] DL §3.9.3

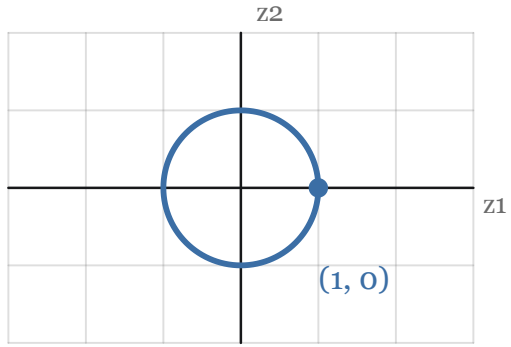
# Gaussian geometry

## Change basis, then standardize

centered original coordinates




divide x1 by its standard deviation



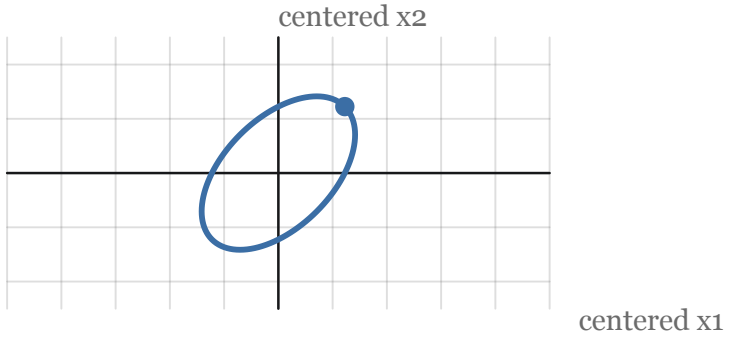

$$\Sigma = Q\Lambda Q^T, \quad z = \Lambda^{-1/2} Q^T (x - \mu)$$

$Q$ eigenvectors; $\Lambda$ positive eigenvalues; $z$ centered with identity covariance; $x, \mu$ position and mean. Plot: $Q = I$, $\Lambda = \mathrm{diag}(4, 1)$.

Whitening; eigendecomposition — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.5 · Course derivation

# Gaussian geometry

## A contour radius becomes an ellipse axis




unit Mahalanobis contour

eigenvalues 3 and 1

$$x = \mu + Q\Lambda^{1/2} z, \qquad \|z\| = c$$

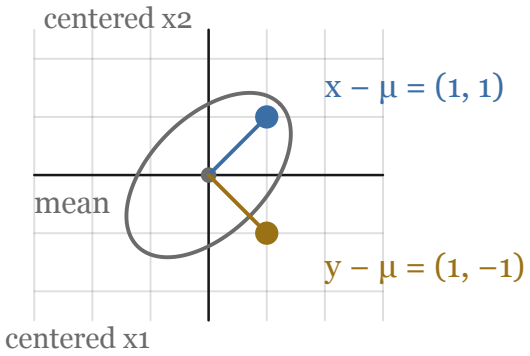
$c$ standardized radius; $\sqrt{\lambda_i}$ standard deviation along eigenvector $q_i$. Plot: $c = 1$, $\lambda = (3, 1)$.

Gaussian density contour — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.5 · Course derivation

LECTURE 8

# Gaussian geometry

## Equal lengths can have unequal surprise




gray ellipse: $d_m = 1$

both arrows: Euclidean length $\sqrt{2}$

$$\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mu = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$\Sigma$ covariance; $\mu$ mean; compare $x = (2, 0)^T$ and $y = (2, -2)^T$.

$$d_M^2(x) = \tfrac{2}{3}, \qquad d_M^2(y) = 2$$

$d_M$ covariance-scaled distance.

Mahalanobis distance — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.5 · Course example

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Gaussian geometry

## Which direction makes a point less surprising?

$\mu = 0, \Sigma = \mathrm{diag}(4, 1)$; $u = (2, 0)^T$, $v = (0, 2)^T$. Compare Gaussian densities.

A $p(u) = p(v)$: their Euclidean lengths agree.

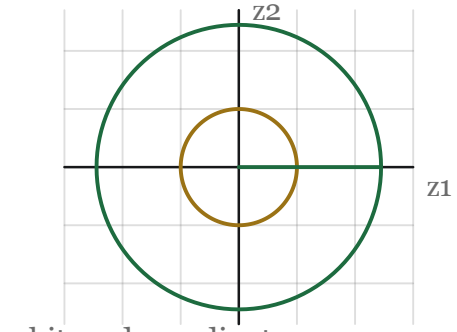
B $p(u) > p(v)$: $u$ is one standard deviation away.

C $p(u) < p(v)$: higher variance always lowers density.

Mahalanobis distance — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.5 · Course question

# Gaussian geometry

## A unit ellipse contains less than half




c = 1: mass 39.3%

c = 2.448: mass 95%

original semiaxes: 4.24 and 2.45

circle radius = Mahalanobis distance

$$P(d_M^2 \le c^2) = 1 - e^{-c^2/2} \quad (d = 2)$$

$c$ contour radius; $d = 2$ dimension; the formula assumes a nonsingular Gaussian. Example: $\lambda_1 = 3, \lambda_2 = 1$.

$$c_{.95} = \sqrt{-2 \log .05} \approx 2.44775$$

$c_{.95}$ radius enclosing 95%.

Chi-square distribution; Gaussian probability region — [3] NIST §1.3.6.6.6 · [3] NIST $\chi^2$ table · Course derivation

# Bayes

## Which population does a positive select?

| joint events | positive + | negative – |
|---|---|---|
| event H | H and + | H and – |
| no event | not H and + | not H and – |

$$P(H \mid +) \text{ need not equal } P(+ \mid H)$$

$H$ event of interest; $+$ positive sensor result; the bar restricts the population.

Conditional probability — [1] DL §3.4–3.5 · Course example

# Bayes

Write the joint event in two ways

$$P(H \mid +) = \frac{P(+ \mid H)P(H)}{P(+)}$$

$P(H)$ prior; $P(+ \mid H)$ likelihood; $P(+) > 0$ evidence. $H$: event; $+$: positive reading.

Bayes' rule — [1] DL §3.11 · Course derivation

# Bayes

## Normalize over both sources of positives

$$P(+) = P(+ \mid H)P(H) + P(+ \mid \neg H)P(\neg H)$$

$\neg H$ complement; the two joint events are disjoint and exhaustive. $H$: event; $+$: positive reading.

Law of total probability; evidence — [1] DL §3.4–3.5 · [1] DL §3.11 · Course derivation

# Bayes

## Rare events can lose the positive majority

| joint events | positive + | negative – |
|---|---|---|
| event H | 90 | 10 |
| no event | 990 | 8910 |

$$P(H) = .01, \quad P(+ \mid H) = .9, \quad P(+ \mid \neg H) = .1$$

10,000 model trials: 100 event cases and 9,900 non-event cases.

$$P(H \mid +) = \frac{90}{90 + 990} = \frac{1}{12}$$

$H$ event; $+$ positive reading.

Prior probability; posterior probability — [1] DL §3.11 · Course example

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Bayes

## Does a better base rate change the sensor?

$P(H) = .1$, $P(+ \mid H) = .9$, $P(+ \mid \neg H) = .1$. What is $P(H \mid +)$?

A .9: sensitivity is the positive predictive value.

B .1: an observation cannot change the prior.

C .5: true and false positives contribute equally.

Prior probability; posterior probability — [1] DL §3.11 · Course question

# Break

Pause: three different kinds of probability

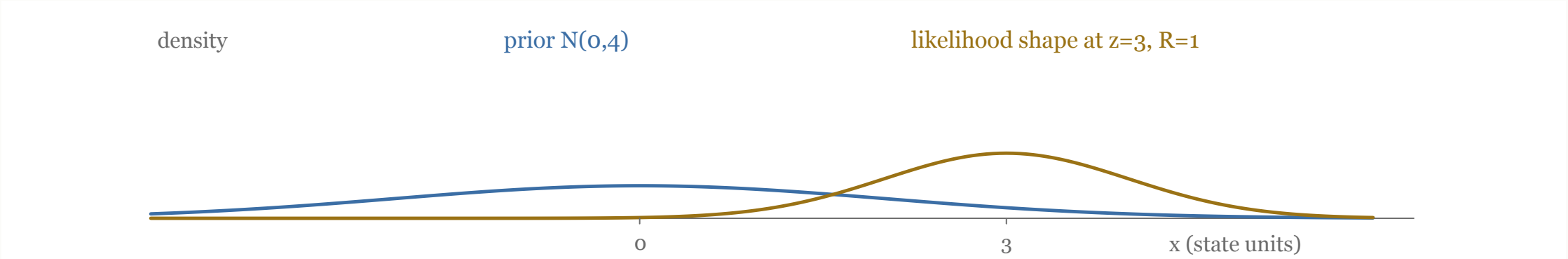
$$P(X \in A), \qquad p(x), \qquad P(H \mid +)$$

$A$ event; $p$ density; conditioning changes the reference population.

Event probability; density; conditional probability — [1] DL §3.3.2 · [1] DL §3.4–3.5 · Course recap

# Gaussian conditioning

## A numeric reading updates a curve




$$x \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_0, P_0), \quad z = x + \varepsilon, \quad \varepsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, R)$$

$x$ uncertain state; $z$ observed value; $P_0, R > 0$ variances; independent noise.

Gaussian prior; Gaussian likelihood — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7

# Gaussian conditioning

Add precisions, then complete the square

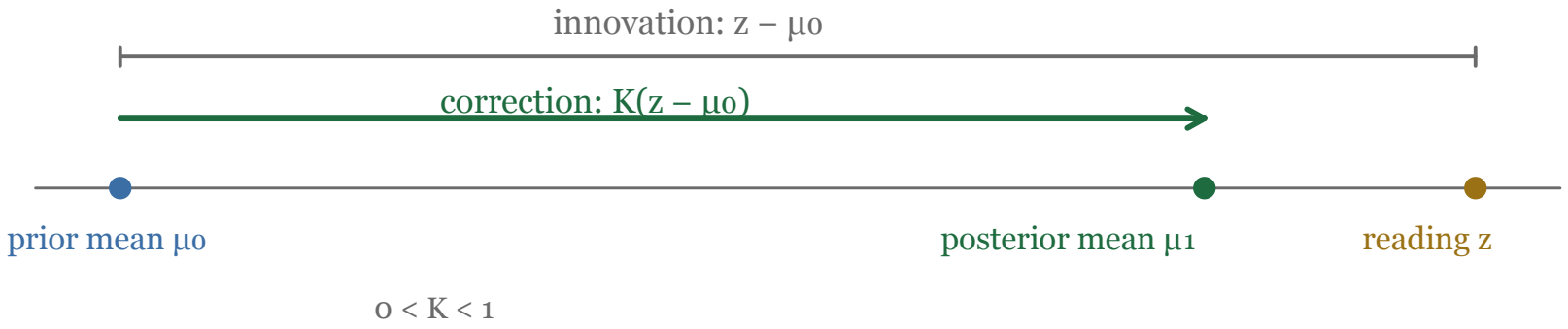
$$J(x) = \frac{(x-\mu_0)^2}{2P_0} + \frac{(z-x)^2}{2R}, \quad P_1^{-1} = P_0^{-1} + R^{-1}, \quad \mu_1 = P_1(\mu_0/P_0 + z/R)$$

$P_1, \mu_1$ posterior variance and mean; inverse variance is precision.

Gaussian posterior; precision — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7 · [1] DL §3.9.3 · Course derivation

# Gaussian conditioning

## The gain weights the innovation



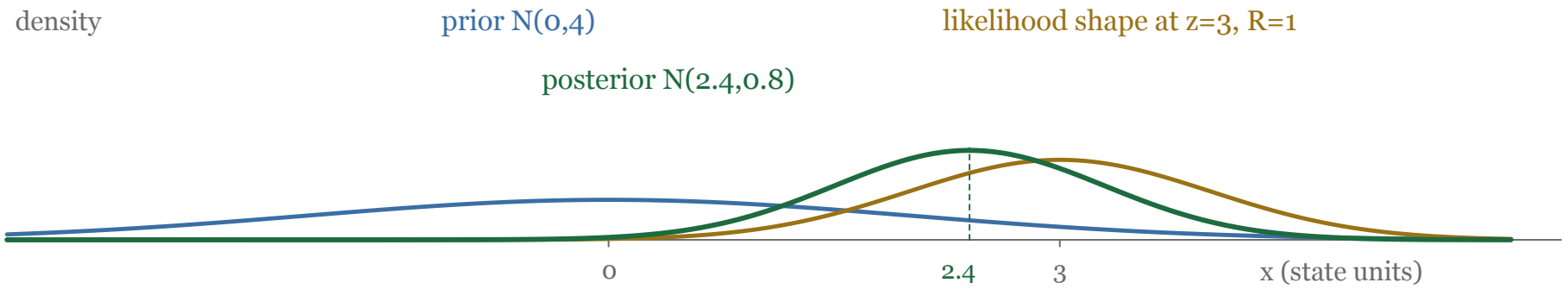

$$\mu_1 = \frac{R\mu_0 + P_0 z}{P_0 + R} = \mu_0 + K(z - \mu_0), \quad K = \frac{P_0}{P_0 + R}, \quad P_1 = (1 - K)P_0$$

$K$ gain; $z - \mu_0$ innovation; $0 < K < 1$ for positive variances.

Kalman gain; measurement innovation — [5] Welch–Bishop §1 · [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7 · Course derivation

# Gaussian conditioning

## Fuse a prior and a precise reading




$$\mu_0 = 0, \quad P_0 = 4, \quad z = 3, \quad R = 1$$

$P_0, R$ are variances, not standard deviations.

$$K = \tfrac{4}{5}, \qquad \mu_1 = 2.4, \qquad P_1 = .8$$

$K$ gain; $\mu_1, P_1$ posterior mean, variance.

Gaussian conditioning — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7 · Course example

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Gaussian conditioning

## What does a noisier reading change?

Prior $\mathcal{N}(0, 4)$, reading $z = 3$. Noise variance rises from $R = 1$ to $R = 4$. What changes?

A Mean moves toward 0; posterior variance increases.

B Mean moves toward 3; posterior variance decreases.

C Only the mean changes; variance ignores sensor noise.

Gaussian conditioning — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7 · Course question

# Gaussian conditioning

## A correlated block predicts another block

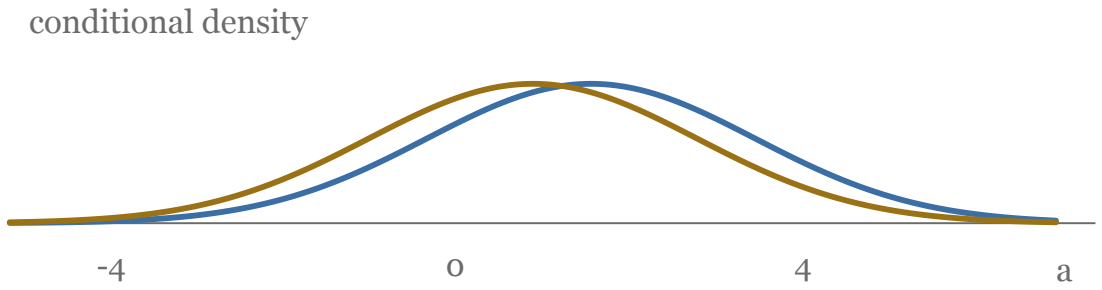
$$\mu_{a|b} = \mu_a + \Sigma_{ab}\Sigma_{bb}^{-1}(b - \mu_b)$$

Jointly Gaussian: every linear combination is normal (possibly constant). Invertible $\Sigma_{bb}$. $a \in \mathbb{R}^p$, $b \in \mathbb{R}^q$; $\Sigma_{ab} : p \times q$.

Conditional Gaussian mean — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7

# Gaussian conditioning

## Conditioning removes predictable variance




b = 5: mean 5/3

b = 2: mean 1

both variances 32/9

$$\Sigma_{a|b} = \Sigma_{aa} - \Sigma_{ab}\Sigma_{bb}^{-1}\Sigma_{ba}$$

Joint Gaussian; $\Sigma_{bb} \succ 0$, $\Sigma_{ba} = \Sigma_{ab}^T$. Plot: $\mu = (1, 2)^T$, $\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 2 \\ 2 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$.

Conditional Gaussian covariance — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Gaussian conditioning

## Does the slice width change?

Gaussian $(a, b)^T$: $\mu = (1, 2)^T$, $\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 2 \\ 2 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$. Observe $b = -1$ instead of 5.

A. Both conditional mean and variance decrease.

B. Mean decreases; conditional variance stays fixed.

C. Neither changes because the joint model is fixed.

Conditional Gaussian distribution — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7 · Course question

# Estimation

## Choose a parameter to explain fixed data

$$b = A\theta + \varepsilon, \qquad \varepsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2 I)$$

$b \in \mathbb{R}^N$ data; $A \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times p}$ known design; $\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p$ unknown; $\sigma^2 > 0$ known noise variance.

Gaussian linear regression; maximum likelihood — [1] DL §5.5.1

# Estimation

## Gaussian products become a squared loss

$$-\log p(b \mid \theta) = \frac{N}{2}\log(2\pi\sigma^2) + \frac{\|b - A\theta\|^2}{2\sigma^2}$$

$A$ known; $b$ observed; $\theta$ unknown; independent errors, each $\mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$, $\sigma^2 > 0$.

Negative log-likelihood; least squares — [1] DL §5.5.1 · Course derivation

# Estimation

The familiar normal equation returns

$$A^T A\hat{\theta} = A^T b, \qquad A^T(b - A\hat{\theta}) = 0$$

$\hat{\theta}$ MLE; full column rank gives uniqueness; residual is orthogonal to columns.

Normal equations; least squares — [1] DL §5.1.4 · Course derivation

# Estimation

## Fit three readings with two coefficients

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad b = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

$\theta = (\text{intercept}, \text{slope})^T$; $r = b - A\hat{\theta}$.

$$\hat{\theta} = \begin{pmatrix} 7/6 \\ 1/2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad r = \begin{bmatrix} -1/6 \\ 1/3 \\ -1/6 \end{bmatrix}$$

$\hat{\theta}$ estimate; $r$ observed minus fitted.

Least-squares estimate — [1] DL §5.1.4 · Course example

# Estimation

## A Gaussian prior sets a penalty scale

$$J(\theta) = \tfrac{1}{2}\|b - A\theta\|^2 + \tfrac{\lambda^2}{2}\|\theta - \mu_0\|^2, \quad \lambda^2 = \sigma^2/\tau^2$$

$\theta \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_0, \tau^2 I)$ isotropic prior: variance $\tau^2$ in every unit direction; $\sigma^2$ noise variance; $\lambda^2$ relative strength.

Maximum a posteriori (MAP); quadratic regularization — [1] DL §5.6.1 · Course derivation

# Estimation

## The prior changes the normal equation

$$(A^TA + \lambda^2 I)\hat{\theta} = A^Tb + \lambda^2\mu_0$$

Example: $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$, $b = (1, 2, 2)^T$, $\mu_0 = 0$, $\lambda^2 = 1$.

$$\hat{\theta}_{MAP} = \begin{pmatrix} 4/5 \\ 3/5 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \|b - A\hat{\theta}\|^2 = \tfrac{2}{5}$$

$\hat{\theta}_{MAP}$ posterior mode; squared residual norm.

MAP normal equations; ridge regularization — [1] DL §5.6.1 · [1] DL §5.1.4 · Course derivation

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Estimation

## What makes the MAP estimate unique?

$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$, $b = (1, 2)^T$; prior center 0, $\lambda^2 = 1$. Why is MAP unique?

- **A** The prior makes the two data columns independent.
- **B** Gaussian noise makes every data fit unique.
- **C** The prior adds curvature along the data null space.

MAP estimate; positive definiteness — [1] DL §5.6.1 · Course question

CHOOSE, EXPLAIN, VOTE

# Integrated board

## Calibration: choose the likelihood

$b = (1, 2, 3)^T$, $b_i = \theta + \varepsilon_i$, $\varepsilon_i \overset{iid}{\sim} \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$. Which data objective fits this model?

- **A** $\frac{1}{2}\sum_i (b_i - \theta)^2$
- **B** $\sum_i |b_i - \theta|$
- **C** $\frac{1}{2}\sum_i (b_i - \theta)^2 + \frac{1}{2}\theta^2$

Gaussian likelihood; maximum likelihood — [1] DL §5.5.1 · Course example

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# Integrated board

## Calibration: combine data and prior

Same readings $(1, 2, 3)$; noise variance 1; prior $\theta \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$.
How does the posterior compare with the MLE?

- **A** Center stays at 2; prior changes only uncertainty.
- **B** Center moves toward 0; precision becomes 4.
- **C** Center moves toward 0; variances add to 4.

Gaussian posterior; MAP estimate — [2] UBC Lec.18 p.7 · [1] DL §5.6.1 · Course example

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# Intervals

## Calibration: confidence coverage

$B_i \mid \theta \sim \mathcal{N}(\theta, 1)$ independently. $C(B) = \bar{B} \pm 1.96/\sqrt{3}$. What does 95% confidence mean?

- (A) This realized interval has 95% posterior mass.
- (B) 95% of future individual readings lie inside it.
- (C) Repeated intervals cover fixed $\theta$ 95% of the time.

Confidence interval; coverage probability — [3] NIST §7.1.4 · Course example

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# Intervals

## Calibration: what does credibility describe?

Observed $b = (1, 2, 3)^T$; $\theta \mid b \sim \mathcal{N}(1.5, .25)$. A 95% credible interval describes which probability?

A 95% posterior mass for $\theta$, with $b$ fixed.

B 95% coverage for every fixed true offset.

C 95% probability for a future noisy reading.

Posterior credible interval — [4] MIT 18.05 §2 · Course example

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# Intervals

## Calibration: why do the intervals differ?

Same data: $C(b) = 2 \pm 1.96/\sqrt{3}$; $I(b) = 1.5 \pm 1.96(.5)$. Why is $I$ shifted and narrower?

- **A** It must have better repeated-sampling coverage.
- **B** The zero-centered prior adds information.
- **C** The physical sensor became less noisy.

Confidence interval; credible interval — [3] NIST §7.1.4 · [4] MIT 18.05 §2 · [1] DL §5.6.1 · Course comparison

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# Transfer

## Calibration: independent transfer

New readings $b = (2, 3)^T$; iid noise $\mathcal{N}(0, 1)$; prior $\theta \sim \mathcal{N}(4, 1)$. Which conclusion is valid?

A. The prior changes the data-only MLE.

B. The prior center can be ignored in MAP.

C. MAP moves above the data mean; MLE stays fixed.

MLE; MAP; confidence and credible intervals — [1] DL §§5.5–5.6 · [3] NIST §7.1.4 · [4] MIT 18.05 §2 · Course question

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# Intervals

## What does the sensor promise?

A specification says “±2 cm, 95%.” Which conclusion is justified without another definition?

- **A** It is a confidence interval for the offset.
- **B** It is a credible interval for the offset.
- **C** None: ask what quantity and probability model it describes.

Confidence; credibility; predictive uncertainty — [3] NIST §7.1.4 · [4] MIT 18.05 §2 · [1] DL §5.6, Eq.5.68 · Course question

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# Synthesis

## Which modeling bridge is valid?

Gaussian noise: independent, equal variance. Gaussian prior: equal variance in every direction. Which chain holds?

A. Independence gives squares; Gaussian noise gives sums.

B. Gaussian noise gives squares; independence gives sums.

C. A Gaussian prior removes the data residual term.

Gaussian likelihood; independence; MAP regularization — [1] DL §§5.5–5.6 · [1] DL §3.7 · Course question

# References

Sources and optional extensions

[1] Goodfellow et al. Deep Learning. MIT Press, 2016.

[2] UBC CS340. Multivariate Gaussian Distributions and LDA. 2011.

[3] NIST/SEMATECH. e-Handbook of Statistical Methods.

[4] Orloff & Bloom. Probability Intervals. MIT 18.05, 2022.

[5] Welch & Bishop. An Introduction to the Kalman Filter. 2004.